Production Readiness Checklist

15 checks I run before anything ships. The same ones that catch missing health checks, untested rollbacks, and silent failures before your users do.

- [ ] **1. Health Checks**
  Every service exposes /health and /ready endpoints. Load balancers and orchestrators use them - not just TCP checks.
- [ ] **2. Liveness vs Readiness**
  Liveness restarts dead containers. Readiness removes them from rotation during startup and dependency outages. Configure both.
- [ ] **3. Resource Limits**
  CPU and memory requests/limits set on every container. No limits = one noisy neighbor takes down the node.
- [ ] **4. Graceful Shutdown**
  App handles SIGTERM: stops accepting traffic, drains connections, then exits. No dropped requests on deploy.
- [ ] **5. Rollback Plan**
  Previous version deployable in under 5 minutes. Database migrations are backwards-compatible or have a down migration tested.
- [ ] **6. Database Backups**
  Automated backups verified by an actual restore test in the last 30 days. Untested backups are not backups.
- [ ] **7. Secrets Management**
  No secrets in code, env files, or container images. Secrets come from a vault or managed secret store with rotation.
- [ ] **8. Log Aggregation**
  Structured logs shipped to a central system. You can trace a request across services by ID without SSHing into boxes.
- [ ] **9. Metrics & Dashboards**
  Golden signals dashboard exists: latency, traffic, errors, saturation. Someone has looked at it this week.
- [ ] **10. Alerting**
  Alerts fire on symptoms (error rate, latency), not just causes (CPU). Every alert has a runbook link and a named owner.

- [ ] **11. Runbook**

  A written runbook covers: what breaks, how you know, what to do first, who to call. New on-call can follow it at 3 AM.

- [ ] **12. Load Testing**

  You know your breaking point. Load tested to at least 2x expected peak traffic with results documented.

- [ ] **13. Security Scan**

  Container images scanned for CVEs in CI. Critical vulnerabilities block the deploy pipeline.

- [ ] **14. CI/CD Gates**

  Deploys require: tests pass, security scan clean, manual approval for production. No direct pushes to prod.

- [ ] **15. On-Call Rotation**

  Someone is explicitly on call with a working escalation path. Alerts go to a person, not a mailing list nobody reads.

Want me to run these checks on your infrastructure?

Book a free 30-minute intro call: aravind-portfolio-next.vercel.app/contact